

RICARDO MARTINS ALVES

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Experienced Staff Backend Engineer with 14 years of progressive expertise in designing and implementing scalable distributed systems. Proven track record of leading technical initiatives, mentoring engineering teams, and delivering high-performance solutions for mission-critical applications. Specialist in cloud architecture, microservices, and database optimization with strong focus on system reliability and code quality.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Backend Engineer

Feedzai

www.feedzai.com

Lisbon, Portugal

March 2021 - Present

Led architecture and implementation of real-time fraud detection pipeline processing 50 million transactions daily across distributed microservices infrastructure. Designed and deployed event-driven system using Kafka and Apache Flink resulting in 35% reduction in detection latency. Mentored team of 8 junior and mid-level engineers on system design principles and best practices. Implemented comprehensive monitoring and alerting strategy using Prometheus and Grafana reducing mean time to resolution by 40%.

Senior Backend Engineer

Synapse Data Ltd

www.synapsedataltd.io

Lisbon, Portugal

August 2018 - February 2021

Architected migration of monolithic payment processing system to microservices reducing deployment time from 4 hours to 15 minutes. Established database optimization practices using advanced indexing strategies and query optimization resulting in 60% improvement in query performance. Implemented LangChain-based natural language processing pipeline for automated customer support classification. Developed comprehensive API documentation and SDKs enabling faster integration for partner teams.

Backend Engineer

Unbabel

www.unbabel.com

Lisbon, Portugal

June 2010 - July 2018

Built core translation management platform supporting processing of over 1 million translations monthly with 99.9% uptime SLA. Implemented data warehouse using dbt for transformation pipelines enabling real-time analytics and reporting capabilities. Designed and optimized PostgreSQL schemas for complex query patterns reducing database load by 45%. Established GitHub Actions CI/CD pipeline automating code quality checks and deployment processes across staging and production environments.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science
Instituto Superior Tecnico, Universidade de Lisboa
Lisbon, Portugal
Graduated: June 2010

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Java, Go, SQL, JavaScript, Scala

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Google Cloud Platform, Azure

Message Queues: Kafka, RabbitMQ, AWS SQS

Technologies: Docker, Kubernetes, Microservices, Apache Flink, gRPC, REST APIs

Tools: Git, Jenkins, Prometheus, Grafana, DataDog, ELK Stack

Methodologies: Agile, System Design, Test-Driven Development, Domain-Driven Design